tales from such huge volumes of data to capture the flavour of almost two centuries was an interesting journey altogether.

While every decade had its own adventure, the World Wars and the Partition were the worst moments for the Indian Railways, as infrastructure was stripped to suit the times. In independent India, success stories like the construction of the 760–km stretch of the western coast rail line, the Konkan Railway, through one of the most difficult terrains of the country, described by British TV presenter Chris Tarrant as India's Extreme Railway, added a contemporary positive flavour to it all.

I felt adding an episode on one of the most gruesome incidents in the twenty-first century—the serial train bomb blasts of Mumbai in 2006—which I personally witnessed and covered for a national newspaper, was necessary to include in an effort to make people aware of modern-day security threats to the railways.

Research for this book has been a learning process and has widened my horizons, offering me kaleidoscopic perspectives to look at the same old Indian Railways in many different ways and forms.

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